LESSON 15

Present Perfect Continuous

We use the Present Perfect Continuous to talk about activities:

- which started in the past and continue up to now

I **have been** study**ing** English since 2005.

We **have been** liv**ing** here for more than 10 years.

George **has been** read**ing** that book for 3 months.

- from the recent past which have results in the present

Sheila's clothes are dirty. She **has been** paint**ing** her room.

Patrick is very tired. He **has been** work**ing** hard.

Your clothes are wet. **Have** you **been** wash**ing** the car?

Expressions often used with the Present Perfect Continuous: ***for, since***.

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We use **for** + a period of time:

FOR
two hours
a long time
50 years
20 minutes
five days
six months
a week
ages
years

We use **since** + the start of a period:

SINCE
8 o'clock
Monday
10 April
June
2022
Christmas
lunchtime
we arrived
I got up

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Formation rules: **have/has been + V-ing** (Also see the tables below.)

They **have been** liv**ing** here ***since 1990***.

They **haven't been** liv**ing** here for a long time.

How long **have** they **been** liv**ing** here?

Pamela **has been** wait**ing** for you ***for an hour***.

Pamela **hasn't been** wait**ing** for you for an hour.

Has Pamela **been** wait**ing** for you for an hour?

Affirmative

I We You They	have	been working here for 10 years.
He/She/(It)	has	

Negative

I We You They	have not (haven't)	been working here for 10 years.
He/She/(It)	has not (hasn't)	

Interrogative

Have	I we you they	been working here for 10 years?
Has	he/she/(it)	

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PRESENT PERFECT SIMPLE	PRESENT PERFECT CONTINUOUS
Focuses on the result	**Focuses on the activity**
You've washed your hair! It looks beautiful!	*I've been gardening. The weather is lovely.*
Says 'how many'	**Says 'how long'**
She's written twenty emails this morning.	*She's been writing emails all day.*
Describes a completed action	**Describes an activity which may continue**
I've finished this book.	*I've been reading this book for a month.*
	When we can see evidence of recent activity
	Your clothes are dirty. Have you been painting?

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